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Unit 6 - Expanding Knowledge on the Topic

PDF Documents

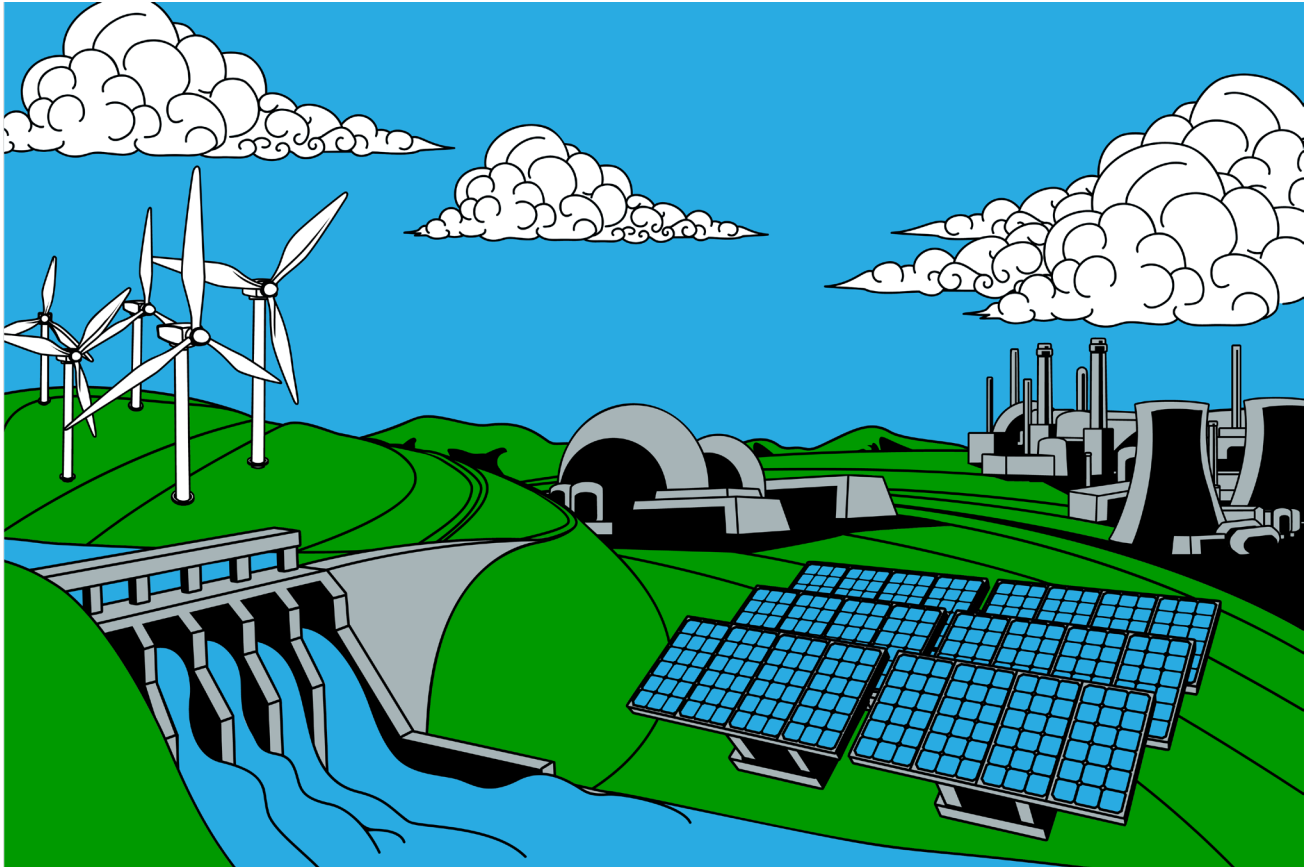
PDF Document 1: 1738067657785-Chapter 5_unit 6 - Expanding Knowledge on the Topic.pdf

This PDF document is included in the unit materials.



UNIT 6 EXPANDING KNOWLEDGE ON THE TOPIC

The Future of Natural Energy Sources



As we delve deeper into the realm of renewable energy, an interesting area of exploration is the sustainability and longevity of natural energy sources. Earth's natural energy reserves, such as sunlight, wind, and geothermal heat, are considered inexhaustible on a human time scale. Unlike fossil fuels, which are finite and deplete with usage, renewable resources regenerate and can supply continuous energy. Solar energy, for example, is harnessed from the sun's radiation, which the sun will emit for another estimated 5 billion years. This makes solar power a particularly sustainable option for the future of energy.

However, while the primary sources of renewable energy are virtually limitless, the infrastructure needed to capture and convert these energies, such as solar panels and wind turbines, requires significant resources and maintenance. The materials used to build these structures, such as rare earth metals and composites, are often scarce and pose their own sustainability challenges. As we look towards a future where renewable energy may become our primary energy source, research

